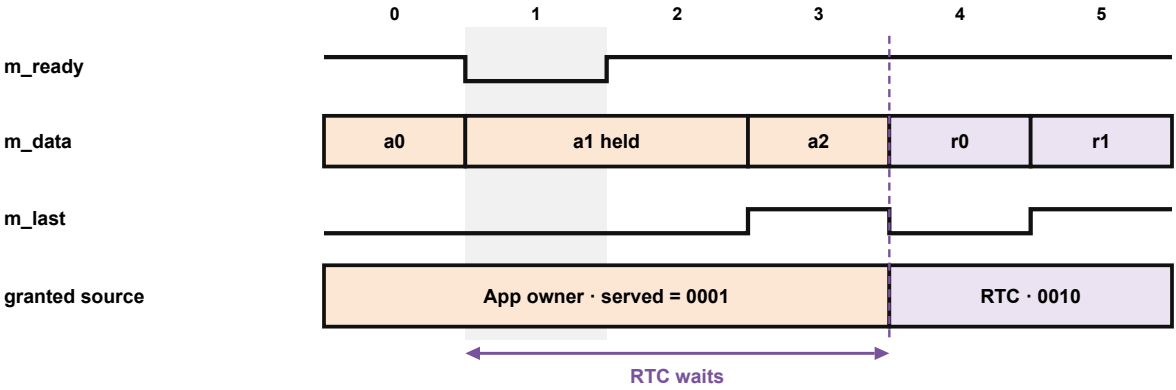
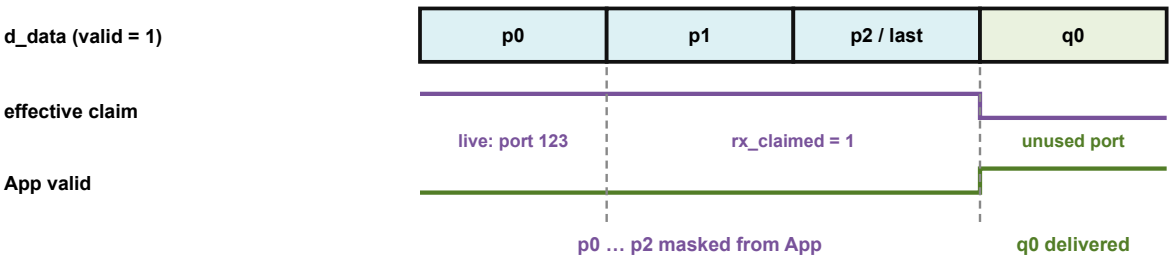
(a) TX arbitration: hold the message owner through back-pressure

App: a0 a1 a2(last) RTC: r0 r1(last), requesting from cycle 1



Cycle 1: a1 stalls. End of cycle 3: a2/last handshakes; RTC starts at cycle 4.

(b) RX port claim: a live first-byte decision becomes a held mask